TOPIC 02 · DATA ANALYTICS AND VISUALIZATION
LAB 6 THEME · AI FUNCTION & FILL WITH GEMINI

Lab 6 — Extract and Categorise Candidate Text with the AI Function

Maps to	LO2: use the AI function (=AI) and Fill with Gemini to extract, categorise and summarise free-text HR data in cells, and measure the accuracy of the AI output against recorded values
Duration	30 minutes
Tools	Google Sheets · AI function (=AI, Generate and insert) · Fill with Gemini · Gemini side panel · OrchidBay_Candidate_Profiles.xlsx
Mock data	data/OrchidBay_Candidate_Profiles.xlsx
Course	Gemini for Google Sheet (C817) · v2.0
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C817-Gemini-for-Google-Sheet/prompts/#lab-6

Goal

Turn 30 free-text candidate summaries and interview notes into structured columns - notice period, sentiment and a manager summary - and measure how accurate they are.

What You Will Do

Hiring managers want a quick read of 30 shortlisted candidates, but the details are buried in free text. You will type =AI formulas that extract the notice period in weeks, classify each interview feedback as Positive, Mixed or Negative, and write a one-line summary that leaves out personal characteristics. You will generate the outputs, compare them with an answer key using formulas, use Fill with Gemini for a skills column, and ask the side panel to group the feedback into themes.

What You Will Build

OrchidBay_Candidate_Profiles with AI-filled Notice_Weeks_AI, Feedback_Sentiment_AI, Manager_Summary_AI and Top_Skills columns, a Checks tab measuring accuracy, and an inserted feedback-themes table

Prerequisites

- The AI function must be available on your account: type =AI(in a cell and check that it is recognised.
- This lab folder downloaded, including data/OrchidBay_Candidate_Profiles.xlsx.

Data note

Use only the supplied fictional Orchid Bay data or information you are authorised to process. Do not paste credentials, confidential business material or real candidates' or employees' personal data into Gemini, the AI function or a Gem unless your organisation has approved it.

Steps

Step 1. Download OrchidBay_Candidate_Profiles.xlsx from this lab's data folder. In Google Drive choose New > File upload, open the uploaded file, then choose File > Save as Google Sheets - Gemini works best on a native Google Sheets file. Close the .xlsx tab and work only in the new Google Sheets copy. At the top right, click Ask Gemini (the spark icon) to open the Gemini side panel. Read the About_This_Data tab before you prompt.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Required state:
File : OrchidBay_Candidate_Profiles (Google Sheets copy)
Tabs : About_This_Data | Profiles (30 rows) | Answer_Key | Checks | Prompt_Log
Empty : F Notice_Weeks_AI | G Feedback_Sentiment_AI | H Manager_Summary_AI
```

Step 2. Type the formula into F2 exactly as shown, then select F2 and click Generate and insert. Check F2 against D2 (CAN-26495): the expected answer is 0. Then copy F2 down to F31 (drag the fill handle), select F2:F31 and click Generate and insert again. Up to 350 selected AI cells generate at once. The range argument (D2) is the only data the function sees.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
AI FUNCTION:
=AI("Extract the notice period in weeks as a whole number. Output only the number. Use 0 for immediately, 4 for one month, 8 for two months and 12 for three months.", D2)
```

Step 3. Categorise the feedback the same way in G2, then fill and generate G2:G31. Row 2 should be Mixed: 'Solid background, but answers on B2B Sales lacked depth. Consider a second interview.'

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
AI FUNCTION:
=AI("Classify this interview feedback as Positive, Mixed or Negative. Output one word only.", E2)
```

Step 4. Write a manager summary in H2 from three cells at once. Generate only H2:H6 - summaries use more of your AI generation limit. Read each one: does it stick to the evidence?

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
AI FUNCTION:
=AI("Write a one-sentence summary of this candidate for the hiring manager, using only the summary and feedback. Do not mention age, gender, race, religion or nationality.", C2:E2)
```

Step 5. Measure accuracy. Paste the check formulas into Checks column B (labels in column A). Answer_Key holds the recorded values: Positive 9, Mixed 16, Negative 5. Note how many of the 30 match. AI output is text and cannot be undone - to change an answer, edit the prompt and click Refresh and insert.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
CHECK:
Notice matches =SUMPRODUCT(--(TO_TEXT(Profiles!F2:F31)=TO_TEXT(Answer_Key!B2:B31)))
Sentiment matches =SUMPRODUCT(--(TRIM(Profiles!G2:G31)=Answer_Key!C2:C31))
Positive (AI) =COUNTIF(Profiles!G2:G31,"Positive")
Mixed (AI) =COUNTIF(Profiles!G2:G31,"Mixed")
```

Step 6. Investigate any mismatch with the side panel. Now that your answers are generated, it is fine for Gemini to read the answer key - it was kept out of the =AI prompts so it could not influence them.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ASK GEMINI:
Compare Profiles column G with Answer_Key column C. Which candidates don't match, and what in the Interview_Feedback text could have caused each difference?
```

Step 7. Fill with Gemini: type Top_Skills in I1 and, in I2, the skills from D2 yourself (e.g. 'CRM, Negotiation, Stakeholder Management'). Select I2:I31 and choose Fill (or drag the fill handle down and pick Fill with Gemini when it is offered). Gemini follows your example for every row. If Fill is not offered on your account, use the AI function instead.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
AI FUNCTION:
=AI("List the skills mentioned in this summary, comma separated, in the same order.", D2)
```

Step 8. Use the side panel to categorise the whole column at once, and insert the result on a new tab named Feedback_Themes. Then check for bias in the generated summaries.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
INSERT:
Group the Interview_Feedback on the Profiles tab into themes and count how many candidates
fall into each theme. Show the result as a table with one example per theme.

ASK GEMINI:
Do any of the summaries in column H mention personal characteristics or anything that should
not be used in a hiring decision?
```

Step 9. Prompt_Log already lists every prompt in this lab with its step. Ask Gemini to recap the conversation, copy each line into What Gemini did, add How I verified in your own words, and choose Keep, Revise or Undo in the Decision dropdown. Google Sheets saves automatically. Tip: the side-panel history is lost when you reload the page, so insert or copy anything you want to keep.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
LOG:
List the prompts I sent you in this conversation. For each one, give a one-line summary of
what you did, so I can copy it into the Prompt_Log tab.
```

Sample Prompts

Use these prompts in the Gemini side panel in Google Sheets (or adapt them). Name the tab and columns, state the output, and always verify the result. The same prompts are in sample-prompts.txt in this lab folder.

Copy-ready prompts online: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C817-Gemini-for-Google-Sheet/prompts/#lab-6

#	Purpose	Prompt
1	AI function	=AI("Does this candidate mention SQL? Answer Yes or No.", D2)
2	AI function	=AI("Write a polite two-sentence email inviting this candidate to a second interview.", B2:C2)
3	Categorise	=AI("Classify the seniority of this candidate as Junior, Mid or Senior based on years of experience.", D2)
4	Side panel	Which five candidates have the most positive feedback? Show their names and positions.
5	Side panel	Summarise the main concerns interviewers raised, with the number of candidates for each.

Test It

Check	Expected result
Notice_Weeks_AI	30 numbers; row 2 = 0; Notice matches close to 30 (recorded: 8 candidates with 8+ weeks).
Feedback_Sentiment_AI	Recorded split Positive 9, Mixed 16, Negative 5; your Sentiment matches count shows how many agree.
Manager_Summary_AI	H2:H6 filled with one sentence each and no personal characteristics.
Top_Skills	I2:I31 filled by Fill with Gemini (or =AI), following your example in I2.
Feedback_Themes	An inserted themes table whose counts add up to 30.

Checkpoint

Lab 7 opens the 2026 year-to-date workbook - 720 applications including the Q3 drive.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
'AI function not available'.	Your plan, admin settings or language setting does not include it. Use the side panel instead: 'For each row, extract the notice period in weeks from Candidate_Summary' and insert the result.
The cell shows the formula but no answer.	Select the cell(s) and click Generate and insert - AI cells do not generate on their own.
You can't generate any more.	You reached a generation limit. Generate fewer cells (e.g. 10 rows) or wait and try later.
Answers come back as '4 weeks' instead of 4.	Make the prompt stricter ('Output only the number'), then Refresh and insert.
The AI output changed after you edited D2.	AI results do not update on their own. Select the cell and click Refresh and insert.

Challenge

Write one =AI formula that returns 'Ready now', 'Within a month' or 'Later' from the summary. Check it against Notice_Weeks_AI with an IFS formula.

Reflection

For which kinds of HR text would you never let =AI output go into a record without a person reading it?